

Week 01: Sets and Counting Principles

Exercise 1. Let the universal set $U = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8\}$ and its subsets:

- $A = \{1, 2, 4, 8\}$
- $B = \{x \in U \mid x \text{ is odd}\}$
- $C = \{5, 6, 7, 8\}$

Find the following sets or calculate the following values:

- (a) $A \cup B$
- (b) $A \cap B$
- (c) $A \setminus B$
- (d) A^c
- (e) $(A \cup B) \setminus C$
- (f) $A^c \cup C$
- (g) $A^c \cap C$
- (h) $|A|, |A| - |B|, |A \setminus C|$

Exercise 2. A person wants to create a 4-digit PIN code. This PIN is formed using digits from the set $\{0, 1, 2, \dots, 9\}$.

- (a) How many ways are there to create the PIN if digits can be repeated?
- (b) How many ways are there to create the PIN if the digits must be distinct?

Exercise 3. A non-leap year has 365 days. Suppose January 1st is a Monday.

- a) How many Sundays are there in this year?
- b) How many Mondays are there in this year?

Exercise 4. A train consisting of 5 carriages stops at a station for 3 passengers to board. How many ways can these 3 passengers board the train if:

- a) Anyone can board any carriage?
- b) Each person boards a different carriage?

Exercise 5. Prove the following equations:

- a) $C_n^0 = C_n^n = 1$ for all $n \in N$.
- b) $kC_n^k = nC_{n-1}^{k-1}$ for all $n \in N$.
- c) $C_n^k + C_n^{k-1} = C_{n+1}^k$ for all $n \in N$ and $k = 1, 2, \dots, n$.
- d) $C_n^k = \frac{n-k+1}{k} C_n^{k-1}$ for all $n \in N$ and $k = 1, 2, \dots, n$.

Exercise 6. Choose 10 arbitrary natural numbers. Prove that there always exists a subset of these 10 numbers such that the sum of its elements is divisible by 10.

Exercise 7. Given 5 arbitrary points located inside a square with a side length of 2 units. Prove that there always exist at least two points among them whose distance is at most $\sqrt{2}$.

Exercise 8. Suppose S is a finite set and $x \in S$ is an element of S . Prove that the number of subsets of S containing x is equal to the number of subsets of S that do not contain x .

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